coursera | MoMA

What Is Contemporary Art? ✕

Today's goals
- Complete any 3 learning items · 3/3
- Watch 2 videos · 2/2
- Complete a graded assessment

Module 1
Introduction to What Is Contemporary Art?
- ✓ Welcome to the course! Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Preview What Is Contemporary Art? Video • 51 sec
- ✓ Course instructors respond: what is contemporary art? Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Suggestions for making the most of the course Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Optional Prompts for Discussion & Reflection Reading • 10 min

Module 2
Media from Television to the Internet

Source It
- ✓ Introduction to Module 2 Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Arthur Jafa, APEX, 2013 Reading • 10 min
- ✓ In the studio with Arthur Jafa | "The place where images overlap is you" Video • 3 min
- ✓ Three approaches to appropriation Reading • 10 min

Share It
- ✓ How do artists and architects share and circulate images? Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Beatriz González on her street posters in Bogotá, 1983 Video • 2 min
- ✓ Two interventions in television and architecture Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Alfredo Jaar on Lament of the Images, 2002 Video • 1 min
- ✓ Dayanita Singh on Museum of Chance, 2013 Video • 3 min

Watch It
- ✓ How are images used to watch and classify us? Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Surveilling, seeing, scanning Reading • 10 min

Play It
- ✓ What do video games and computers have to do with art and design? Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Susan Kare on designing the first Mac icons, 1980s Video • 3 min
- ✓ JODI on turning desktop order inside out Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Serious games and artificial intelligence Reading • 10 min

Review & Respond
- ✓ Memory Check Practice Assignment • Grade: 90%
- ✓ Reflect on Module 2 Learnings Dialogue • 15 min
- ✓ Optional Readings & Resources Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Territories & Transit

Borders & Transit
- ✓ Introduction to Module 3 Reading • 10 min
- ✓ In the studio with Rael San Fratello | Transforming the wall Video • 5 min
- ✓ Bouchra Khalili on The Mapping Journey Project, 2008–11 Video • 3 min
- ✓ Crossing borders Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Mateo López on Travel without Movement, 2008–10 Video • 2 min

Place
- ✓ Claiming space Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Shellyne Rodriguez on Martin Wong, Stanton near Forsyth Street, 1983 Video • 1 min
- ○ **Changing states** Reading • 10 min
- ○ IRWIN on NSK Garda, 2002 Video • 1 min
- ○ Sky Hopinka on Jáaji Approx., 2015 Reading • 10 min
- ○ Amanda Williams on Color(ed) Theory Suite, 2014–16 Video • 2 min
- ○ Portfolio: Teresa Margolles, Pista de baile (Dance Floor), 2016 Reading • 10 min

Review & Respond
- ○ Memory Check Practice Assignment
- ○ Reflect on Territories & Transit Dialogue • 15 min
- ○ Mid-course survey Reading • 5 min
- ○ Optional Readings & Resources Reading • 10 min

Module 4
Materials & Making

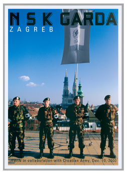
Module 5
Agency

Module 6
Power

Changing states

1:12 / 5:44 1x

IRWIN, *NSK Garda Zagreb*, *NSK Garda Cetinje*, *NSK Garda Pristina*, 2002

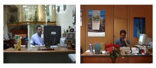

NSK GARDA
ZAGREB
IRWIN in collaboration with Croatian Army, Dec. 10, 2000

IRWIN. *NSK Garda Zagreb*. 2002 (printed 2006). Digital print, composition: 26 3/8 × 18 1/2" (67 × 47 cm); sheet: 27 9/16 × 19 11/16" (70 × 50 cm). Publisher: Galeria Gregor Podnar. Printer: Matformat, Ljubljana, Slovenia. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. The Associates Fund. © 2019 IRWIN

In 1983, five like-minded Slovenian artists formed a collective called IRWIN. A year later, they joined with other collectives to create an umbrella group called NSK (standing for New Slovenian Art). At the time, Slovenia was one of six republics in an increasingly unstable alliance as Yugoslavia, and the artists of NSK were chafing under the policies of the country's art institutions. "We… decided not only to create art but to build an independent support system…," said member Borut Vogelnik about NSK's genesis.

As Yugoslavia broke apart in the early 1990s, NSK responded by becoming NSK State in Time: a landless state with its own flag, passports, and open-door citizenship policy. "NSK confers the status of state not upon territory but upon the mind, whose borders are in a state of flux," it declared. Among the many projects generated out of NSK is IRWIN's series of military posters. IRWIN traveled to the newly independent republics and recruited soldiers in their militaries to don an NSK armband and stand guard beneath the NSK flag. They then photographed the soldiers and produced posters that simultaneously mimic nationalistic propaganda while uniting the soldiers of warring republics under the flag of an imaginary state with no territory to dispute.

Emily Jacir, *Ramallah/New York*, 2004–05

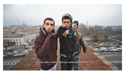


Emily Jacir. Still from *Ramallah/New York*. 2004–05. Two-channel video (color, sound), 38:50 min. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Fund for the Twenty-First Century. © 2019 Emily Jacir

"A lot of my work is…about me wandering through space and time," Emily Jacir has said. She calls many places home, including the cities of Ramallah and New York, where she captured the everyday scenes that make up her two-channel video, *Ramallah/New York*.

Jacir set up her camera in similar businesses in both cities—among them travel agencies, convenience stores, hair salons, and shawarma shops—and recorded moments from a typical day. Patrons come and go; proprietors and employees alternately attend to customers or wait for someone to come by. The vignettes play on adjacent monitors, encouraging us to search for clues that would distinguish which city they were shot in. But there is little apparent difference between them, and details that might seem to point to place—a poster of the Statue of Liberty in New York hangs in the Ramallah travel agency—can be misleading.

Halil Altindere, *Wonderland*, 2013


all your talk is nothing until you come and live here.

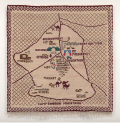
Halil Altindere. Still from *Wonderland*. 2013. Video (color, sound), 8:25 min. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Acquired through the generosity of Wendy Fisher. © 2019 Halil Altindere. Courtesy the artist and Pilot Gallery

Halil Altindere's rap video-documentary, *Wonderland*, stemmed from his concern with a government-led urban renewal plan in Istanbul. In 2006, the Turkish government's housing authority (TOKI) began demolishing and rebuilding the historic neighborhood of Sulukule, home to Istanbul's Romani population.

Wonderland opens with a young man racing away from policemen who pursue him through streets filled with rubble, past hollowed out buildings and graffiti-covered walls. The young man belongs to Tahribad-I Isyan (Rebellion of Destruction), a group of activist Romani rappers who protest the destruction of Sulukule through hip-hop. Impressed with the group's work, Altindere collaborated with them on *Wonderland*. The video conveys their rage, despair, and defiance as they rap about their displacement while running through their disappearing neighborhood, at one point attacking a police officer and at another getting shot at.

Watch *Wonderland* (Note: In this posting, the video is followed by an interview with Altindere, which you are free to enjoy but which is not required viewing for the course.)

Manuel Herz Architects, National Union of Sahrawi Women, Woven Panel, 2016



Manuel Herz Architects, National Union of Sahrawi Women. Woven Panel. 2016. Woven wool, 98 7/16 × 102 3/8" (250 × 260 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of Jo Carole and Ronald S. Lauder

A collaboration between German architect Manuel Herz and a group of weavers from the artists' collective National Union of Sahrawi Women, this hand-loomed wall panel depicts a map of the Rabouni refugee camp, which serves as the administrative center for a network of camps clustered in southwestern Algeria. These camps house the Sahrawi people, who fled a war with Morocco that broke out in their home territory of Western Sahara in 1975. Although the fighting ended in 1991, Western Sahara remains disputed and the Sahrawi remain in limbo.

The map highlights Rabouni's ministries, signifying a semi-autonomous government that oversees education, defense, construction, and other areas essential to any nation. So while they wait to reclaim a permanent place in Western Sahara, the Sahrawi have built the components of their future nation-state.

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